# Statement

Sensitive

**Statement in the matter of R v R v Vida Reid**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Name** | Paul Gilbert |
| **Occupation** | Utility Worker |
| **Address** | Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) |
| **Date** | 13 October 2022 |

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Paul Gilbert and I am 30 years of age.

3. My residential address is known to the National Disability Insurance Scheme.

4. I am a participant of the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS). I became a NDIS participant in 2020. My NDIS participant number is 431092172. I have Autism and I require supports with independent living, meal preparation, social skills and household cleaning. My first plan was dated 12 August 2020 until 1 September 2021 and was to the value of $14,447.98. My current plan is dated 12 October 2022 until 12 October 2023 and is to the value of $183,234.12.

5. My understanding of the NDIS to create more independence for people with disability and provide assistance to enjoy quality of life, as well as upskilling people for potential in life things, like work.

6. My current support coordinator is Adrian TEAR from Diversitas WA who has been my support coordinator for two days. Previously it was Anthony from St Judes.

P. Gilbert

A. LAING.

between 19 April 2022 and 1 September 2022. I looked at these claims. Forward Focus Group and Hive never spent time with me after I got my accommodation. I have never had any physical supports from Forward Focus Group or Hive.

14. On the claims list I can see on the 5 May 2022 Forward Focus Group have claimed 29 hours for Coordination of Supports. I have not had support co-ordination for 29 hours, they have not come to my house, they have not given me services. For some reason they never visited me.

15. On the 4 August 2022 I wrote an email to Alex Bowers at Forward Focus Group. I made a complaint that I felt that I was being ignored by Blake and Forward Focus Group. I had sent emails to Vida Reid saying I felt neglected. He would never call me back and I was not being supported. I never got a response from Forward Focus Group.

**EXHIBIT: I NOW PRODUCE EXHIBIT NUMBERED PG001 – EMAIL DATED 4 AUGUST 2022**

16. I received an email from Alex Bowers at Forward Focus Group for a men's retreat at the Margaret River from the 15 to 20 September 2022. I called Alex and he told me it would cost about $6000 to $10,000. I did not agree to this and this is not a right way to spend NDIS funds. I responded to the email and told Alex I was not happy with the management and the company hosting respites.

**EXHIBIT: I NOW PRODUCE EXHIBIT NUMBERED PG002 – EMAIL DATED 5 SEPTEMBER 2022**

**EXHIBIT: I NOW PRODUCE EXHIBIT NUMBERED PG003 – EMAIL DATED 6 SEPTEMBER 2022.**

17. This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

P. Gilbert Paul Gilbert

A. LAING.

7. My mother is using Forward Focus Group as a NDIS Provider and in February 2022 when my Dad died, I needed help and my mum suggested Forward Focus Group.

8. In late February Vida Reid, the director and Blake Sadler the support co-ordinator of Forward Focus Group came to my house. They told me they could help me and assist me in finding a place for me to live. They offered independent living supports. I signed a service agreement with them as a support coordinator. I signed the service agreement electronically, but I did not get a copy of this service agreement.

9. Within the week they found me a place to live. I was in temporary short accommodation and then I moved into my place in July 2022. I was told and it was in the agreement that I was paying $220 per week. Blake told me $1800 would come out of my funding to allow me to live here. It wasn't a bond. He told me water was paid by the strata. I have never had an electricity bill and I have never lived by myself so I didn't know what happens with electricity.

10. I was in touch with Blake and I said I wanted to live in something long term. Blake told me an occupational therapist would come out to assess me. He told me that I needed six hours a day of services but he wouldn't tell me what those services were.

11. I did have an occupational therapist called Alicia from All Round Occupational Therapy come to me, I don't recall the date. She spoke to me about what I need and filled out some forms. I never got a report or what was the result.

12. In September 2022 I got an email from Tracey from Assist Plan Managers asking if I had received the services from Hive, initiated by Forward Focus Group. She sent me invoices from Hive. I looked at them and I had not received the services. These invoices were in June 2022 for Skills Development and Training. I can see these claims on the list dated 9 June, 16 June, 23 June and 30 June. I have never had any skills development and training services or supports.

13. On Thursday 13 October 2022 I met with Amanda Laing from the NDIS Fraud Taskforce who spoke to me about claims made by Forward Focused Group dated

P. Gilbert A. Laing

Signature _____
Paul Gilbert

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 1:00 PM on 13 October 2022 at Rockingham in Western Australia.

Signature _____
Amanda Laing
Rockingham, Western Australia

## Laing, Amanda

**From:** Paul Gilbert <paulgilbert1992@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, 13 October 2022 4:16 PM
**To:** Laing, Amanda
**Subject:** Fwd: Regarding Support Codoniator

You don't often get email from paulgilbert1992@gmail.com. Learn why this is important

---------- Forwarded message ----------
From: **Paul Gilbert** <paulgilbert1992@gmail.com>
Date: Thursday, August 4, 2022
Subject: Regarding Support Codoniator
To: Alex.b@ffg.net.au

HI alex paul here i hope this is the last time i have too put a complaint in but not very happy with blake he says he will sort issues that i bring up but never rings back when he says he would about it so i end up having too sort them out myself not fair as you guys are funded on my plan too follow up things and get back too me really feel lack of support right now can you email me back or email me as i feel like im being ignored?

Kind Regards Paul

## Laing, Amanda

**From:** Paul Gilbert <paulgilbert1992@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, 13 October 2022 4:26 PM
**To:** Laing, Amanda
**Subject:** Fwd: Margret River - Men's Retreat

You don't often get email from paulgilbert1992@gmail.com. Learn why this is important

---------- Forwarded message ----------
From: **Paul Gilbert** <paulgilbert1992@gmail.com>
Date: Tuesday, September 6, 2022
Subject: Margret River - Men's Retreat
To: Alex Bowers <alex.b@ffg.net.au>

Hi Alex not very happy still with some of the things currently going on in management don't appreciate the company always hosting respites too use current funding from plans and not host of help people that are paticapants with getting particular jobs or helping with job career growth something needs too be done regarding this issue can someone contact me asap

On Monday, September 5, 2022, Alex Bowers <alex.b@ffg.net.au> wrote:

> Good afternoon,
>
> This is Alex from Forward Focused Group here again with another amazing offer for a 5-day men's mental Health Getaway in Margret River form the 15th – 20th of September.
>
> we are looking at having a wonderful time down there with Lucas Brown and some amazing therapists, some of our staff and more!
>
> Details regarding the events that will be held during the 5 days will be sent to you via email within the next couple of days.
>
> If you or someone you know, who is a NDIS participant and would benefit from this please feel free to forward this email to them and kindly ask them to contact myself on the number below.
>
> I hope to hear from you soon. Hope you have an amazing afternoon.
>
> Thank you for your time.



**Alex B**

Client Liaison Coordinator, Forward Focused Group

2/210 Jull street, Armadale, WA 6112 [Next to Dome Cafe]

08-61177786 0478 890 867 Alex.B@ffg.net.au

https://forwardfocusedgroup.com.au

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Registered NDIS Provider

Workforce Australia
Employment Services